JAMES RICHARDSON

Data Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a data engineer with five years of experience building scalable data pipelines and data infrastructure. I've worked with teams across fintech and e-commerce, designing systems that process millions of records daily. I enjoy solving complex data problems and have a particular interest in optimizing ETL workflows and improving data quality at source.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer

DataFlow Systems Ltd

www.dataflow-systems.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2023 - Present

Designed and implemented a real-time data ingestion platform processing 50 million events daily from multiple payment gateways using Apache Kafka and Python, reducing latency from 45 minutes to under 2 minutes.

Optimized existing Spark jobs that were consuming excessive resources, reducing monthly cloud costs by 35 percent through query restructuring and partitioning strategy improvements.

Mentored two junior data engineers on best practices for data pipeline development, code review processes, and troubleshooting production issues.

Built data quality monitoring dashboards using Great Expectations and Tableau, identifying and flagging 12 critical data anomalies before they impacted downstream analytics.

Data Engineer

CloudBridge Analytics

www.cloudbridge-analytics.net

Cambridge, United Kingdom

July 2021 - February 2023

Developed and maintained 20+ ETL pipelines using Python and SQL that extracted data from legacy systems, transformed it for analytics, and loaded it into our Snowflake data warehouse.

Implemented automated testing and CI/CD pipelines for data jobs using GitHub Actions, reducing deployment time from 4 hours to 15 minutes and preventing three production incidents.

Collaborated with product and analytics teams to understand data requirements, then architected dimensional models supporting complex business intelligence reporting.

Documented data lineage and created technical specifications for ten major data integration projects, improving onboarding time for new team members by 40 percent.

Junior Data Engineer

Vertex Solutions

www.vertex-solutions.co

Cambridge, United Kingdom

June 2019 - June 2021

Wrote SQL queries and Python scripts to extract data from PostgreSQL and MySQL databases, performing exploratory analysis to support business reporting needs.

Assisted in migrating batch processing workflows from shell scripts to Apache Airflow, improving job scheduling reliability and providing better visibility into pipeline execution.

Supported data warehouse maintenance activities including performance tuning, backup procedures, and user access management across 15 team members.

Investigated and resolved data pipeline failures, documenting root causes and implementing preventive measures to reduce recurring issues.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science (Upper Second Class Honours)

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

2015 - 2018

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Tools: Python, SQL, Java, Bash

Data Platforms: Snowflake, Apache Spark, Apache Airflow, Apache Kafka

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, BigQuery, Redshift

Cloud Services: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform

Data Quality and Testing: Great Expectations, pytest, dbt

Version Control: Git, GitHub

Visualization: Tableau, Looker

Other: Linux, Docker, Apache Beam, JSON/XML parsing